

8 Noah

The righteous man who found grace, built the ark, and received God's covenant with every living creature.

Noah lived when "the wickedness of man was great in the earth," and God resolved to send a flood. But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD. A just man who walked with God, he built an ark, brought his family and the animals inside, and came through the flood alive. Afterward God made a covenant never again to destroy the earth by flood, sealed with the rainbow. His story ends honestly, with drunkenness and a family rift. Scripture treats him as a model of faith and a warning about the days before Christ's return.

At a glance

Name	Hebrew <i>Noach</i> , linked to "rest" and "comfort"
Family	Son of Lamech; sons Shem, Ham and Japheth
Household saved	Eight people (Genesis 7:13; 1 Peter 3:20)
Key places	The ark; "the mountains of Ararat" (Genesis 8:4)
Key people	Shem, Ham, Japheth, Canaan
Lifespan	950 years (Genesis 9:29)
Main passages	Genesis 5:28–9:29
New Testament	Matthew 24:37–39; Hebrews 11:7; 1 Peter 3:20

"Thus did Noah; according to all that God commanded him, so did he."

Genesis 6:22, KJV

The life of Noah

Ages come from the Hebrew text of Genesis. The Greek Septuagint gives different numbers for earlier generations. Christians differ on whether the flood covered the whole globe or the whole region known to Noah.

Lamech's 182nd year	● Born Lamech names him Noah, saying, "This same shall comfort us concerning our work and toil of our hands." <i>Genesis 5:28-29</i>
Age 500	● Father of three sons Noah fathers Shem, Ham and Japheth. <i>Genesis 5:32</i>
Before the flood	● Finds grace God sees the earth filled with violence and resolves to destroy it. "But Noah found grace in the eyes of the LORD." <i>Genesis 6:5-13</i>
Before the flood	● Builds the ark God gives the ark's plan: 300 cubits long, 50 wide and 30 high. Noah does all that God commands. <i>Genesis 6:14-22</i>
Age 600	● Enters the ark Noah's family and the animals go in, and the LORD shuts them in. Rain falls forty days and forty nights. <i>Genesis 7:1-16</i>
Age 600	● The ark rests After the waters prevail 150 days, the ark rests on the mountains of Ararat. Noah sends out a raven and then a dove. <i>Genesis 7:24-8:12</i>
Age 601	● Leaves the ark The earth is dry. Noah builds an altar, and God makes his covenant, sealed with the rainbow. <i>Genesis 8:13-9:17</i>
Age 950	● Dies Noah lives 350 years after the flood. <i>Genesis 9:28-29</i>

Key activities

"The mountains of Ararat" names a region, later called Urartu. Genesis does not say which peak. The curse in Genesis 9 falls on Canaan, not on Ham, and gives no basis for later claims that it applied to any race.

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- I Found grace.** Amid a violent world, God looked on Noah with favor. *Genesis 6:8*

 - 2 Walked with God.** He was "a just man and perfect in his generations." *Genesis 6:9*

 - 3 Built the ark.** He built it to God's exact plan. *Genesis 6:14-22*

 - 4 Preached righteousness.** Peter calls him "a preacher of righteousness." *2 Peter 2:5*

 - 5 Gathered the animals.** He brought pairs of every kind, and the clean animals by sevens. *Genesis 6:19-20; 7:2-3*

 - 6 Obeyed and entered.** He went in with his family, and the LORD shut them in. *Genesis 7:5-16*

 - 7 Waited and watched.** He sent out a raven and then a dove. The dove brought back an olive leaf, and the next time it did not return. *Genesis 8:6-12*

 - 8 Waited for God's word.** He left the ark only when God told him to. *Genesis 8:15-19*

 - 9 Built an altar.** He offered burnt offerings of every clean beast and fowl. *Genesis 8:20-21*

 - 10 Received the covenant.** God blessed him and promised never again to flood the earth. The rainbow is the token. *Genesis 9:1-17*

 - II Planted a vineyard and fell.** He became drunk and lay uncovered in his tent. Ham saw and told his brothers, who covered their father. *Genesis 9:20-23*

 - 12 Spoke blessing and curse.** He cursed Canaan and blessed Shem and Japheth. *Genesis 9:24-27*

Across Scripture

Direct references come first. Thematic echoes are study connections, not places where the text names Noah.

Old Testament

Genesis 5:28–9:29	The main account of his life
Genesis 10	The nations descend from Noah's three sons
Isaiah 54:9	God's promise is "as the waters of Noah unto me"
Ezekiel 14:14, 20	Noah, Daniel and Job named as righteous men

New Testament

Matthew 24:37–39; Luke 17:26–27	"As the days of Noe were"
Luke 3:36	Noah in the genealogy of Jesus
Hebrews 11:7	By faith he "prepared an ark to the saving of his house"
1 Peter 3:20–21	"Eight souls were saved by water," a picture of baptism
2 Peter 2:5; 3:5–7	God spared Noah and will judge again
Echo: Revelation 4:3	A rainbow surrounds God's throne

For discussion

1. *Observe:* How does Genesis describe Noah's obedience (Genesis 6:22; 7:5)?
2. *Understand:* Noah "found grace" before he built anything. Why does that order matter?
3. *Apply:* Where do you need courage to obey when others around you won't?
4. *Apply:* Noah's family covered his shame (Genesis 9:23). How can you show grace when someone you love fails?